

Step	Actions/Tasks
1: Understand & Setup	Open Excel → Load dataset → Observe rows & columns → Understand what each column represents → Identify objective of analysis/report → Select entire dataset
2: Basic Structure Formatting	Adjust column widths → Select header row → Apply bold (Ctrl + B) → Apply fill color → Center align text → Select full dataset → Apply all borders
3: Data Cleaning & Preparation	Identify unnecessary columns → Hide (preferred) / Delete if sure → Select numeric columns → Format as currency (\$) → Set decimal places → Select date columns → Format into readable dates → Select cell below header → Freeze panes
4: Filtering & Data Organization	Select dataset → Apply filters (Ctrl + Shift + L) → Use dropdowns to filter data → Search using (Ctrl + F) → Create separate sheets if required → Copy (Ctrl + C) and paste (Ctrl + V) filtered data
5: Navigation & Selection Efficiency	Move across data using (Ctrl + Arrow keys) → Select large ranges using (Shift + Ctrl → Arrow keys)
6: Sorting (Core Analysis)	Select dataset → Go to Data → Sort → Sort by Region (A–Z) → Add level: Province (A–Z) → Add level: Sales (Largest → Smallest)
7: Conditional Formatting (Insights)	Select Sales column → Apply Top 10% rule → Highlight with green → Select Profit column → Apply color scale → Set green for profit → Set red for loss → Use Manage Rules for multiple conditions
8: Advanced Formatting (Report Readability)	Identify sections (e.g., Region groups) → Apply double bottom borders → Select long text cells → Apply wrap text → Adjust alignment
9: Error Handling & Efficiency	Undo (Ctrl + Z) → Redo (Ctrl + Y) → Save frequently (Ctrl + S)
10: Printing & Output	Go to Print (Ctrl + P) → Set orientation → Adjust margins → Scale to fit pages → Preview layout
11: Finalization & Security	Save file (Ctrl + S) → Rename properly → Export as PDF → Protect sheet (password) → Save final version → Review readability and clarity